TLP:CLEAR

INCIDENT REPORT

Fake YouTube DMCA Notice Delivered through a Google Group: the "Copyright Library" Kit

Phishing • Google Groups • share.google • Fake DMCA Notice • Credential Theft • Cybercrime

Parameter	Value
Analysis Date	**21 October 2026**
Classification	**Credential phishing: fake YouTube copyright notice**
Threat Actor	**Not identified; Russian-language developer (interface strings), engine "collabix"; relation to a PhaaS family of April 2026 not confirmed by the code; not linked to the parallel Hetzner-themed case (High)**
Targets	**Owners of YouTube channels and members of the abused group**
Affected Systems	**Google accounts of recipients**
Key Techniques	**Google Groups delivery, share.google short link, Browser-in-the-Browser window with a live operator, second-factor interception, obfuscator.io, domain lock and DOM noise**
Threat Level (campaign risk assessment)	**HIGH**
Sources	**Message headers and body; passive DNS, certificate transparency, RDAP, public scan archives**

1. Executive Summary

On 13 October 2026 a fake YouTube copyright notice was distributed through a Google group to its members; it was reported to us on 21 October. The link leads to a live credential-phishing kit that imitates a DMCA strike and a Google sign-in overlay. A separate message investigated in parallel is not related to this campaign (High confidence).

The message was posted to a Google group and distributed to its members with Google's own DKIM signature. Its link is a share.google short link that resolves to copyright-library[.]com, a live "Copyright Library" kit: the visitor enters a channel link, sees a fake "DMCA strike 1/3" and is pushed into a Browser-in-the-Browser window that imitates a Google sign-in. The window is driven in real time by an operator, and the kit supports capture of the password and of all common second factors. The kit hides behind obfuscator.io, a domain lock and DOM noise.

Impact: credential theft aimed at Google accounts of channel owners. No compromise of a victim was observed. Campaign risk assessment: High (interception of second factors with a live operator).

Key findings:

- Delivery through a Google group: Google distributes the post to every member with its own valid DKIM/SPF/DMARC, so mail authentication and domain reputation do not help; the link is a share.google short link.
- The visible link text (youtube.studio/dmca-policy/alerts) is a domain that is not registered; the real target is copyright-library[.]com (registered 3 October 2026).
- The kit is not a static form: it is a Browser-in-the-Browser window orchestrated by a script that claims a live operator slot, polls for operator commands every 5 seconds and reports the victim's current step; the supported factors are password, Google prompt, SMS, TOTP, code to a recovery e-mail, phone number and backup codes.
- The kit's domain lock allows two further domains that currently resolve (ytchannelinfo[.]com, verify1you-be-main213047298[.]com); they are most likely parallel or staging installations (not verified).
- Facts about the code: engine marker "collabix", build v=20261016h (16 October 2026), Russian-language interface strings and hl=ru in an embedded Google URL. A relation to the PhaaS family described in April 2026 is not confirmed by the code.

2. Incident Timeline

Date / time	Event
2026-10-02 / 03	dmcaalertsinfo[.]com and copyright-library[.]com registered
2026-10-05 / 06	copyright-library[.]com delegated to a DNS provider and pointed to 94[.]26[.]90[.]86; page last modified 06 Oct
2026-10-08 / 11	Public URL scans of the kit domain (different tracking-parameter values)
2026-10-13	Message distributed through a Google group
2026-10-16	Version tag of the kit script (v=20261016h)

3. Fake YouTube DMCA Notice

Delivery. The text of the message ("Account Update Information") claims that content on the recipient's account was flagged for a copyright compliance review; the visible link text is youtube.studio/dmca-policy/alerts (a domain that is not registered) while the actual href is a share.google short link. The message was posted to a Google group, so Google delivers it to every member with its own

valid DKIM/SPF/DMARC; the group display name is "YouTube". The authentication results and a sender marker in the headers indicate that the post was made from a consumer Gmail account (Medium). A group message is a fan-out to a member list, not a targeted attack.

Redirect chain. share.google answers 302 to a google.com share endpoint, which answers 301 to copyright-library[.]com. The domain was registered on 2026-10-03 (NiceNIC), uses ClouDNS and resolves to 94[.]26[.]90[.]86 (DEDIK, AS207043); a sibling domain, dmcaalertsinfo[.]com (registered 2026-10-02), shared the same address from 3 to 10 October. The page is served by nginx with an Express application and was last modified on 6 October. Public scans of the same domain on 8 and 11 October carry different values of a tracking query parameter, so that parameter labels the distribution channel or affiliate.

The kit ("Copyright Library"). The visitor enters a YouTube channel link or @handle, sees "There is a DMCA strike on your channel ... 1/3 strikes" and a "Sign in with Google" button. Before the iframe with the sign-in overlay opens, an inline script sends a POST to /api/submit-form with a JSON body (channel link, channel name, case ID, video ID, visitor IP obtained from a public IP-echo service, OS, ref). The overlay (auth-verifi/?continue_verifi_userID_182iqqUTqwjRequestYoutube, 148 KB) contains fake jscontroller/jsaction/jsname attributes, hidden data-noise elements and a developer comment "anti-screenshot disabled per request" to defeat detectors. config.js is a template file with placeholder "brands" (netflix, oracle, riot and others) and fictitious company details, which suggests a built or sold kit.

3.1 Static analysis of script.js

script.js (265,737 bytes) was deobfuscated statically; it was not executed. It is not a plain credential form but the orchestrator of a Browser-in-the-Browser (BitB) window: a fake browser window with a fake address bar (paths of accounts.google.com, a padlock, a certificate window, a draggable title bar) in skins for Windows (Chrome, Firefox), macOS, iOS (Safari, Chrome) and Android. The sign-in steps themselves are loaded into an inner iframe.

Operator session in real time. The script claims a slot from the backend (POST /youtube/api/slot/claim; if all slots are busy the backend answers 503 and the victim sees a Russian-language message that all slots are busy, with live/collecting counters). Every 5 seconds it polls /youtube/api/slot/ping and executes operator commands (restart with a final redirect, forced return to the page that offers a choice of second factor). Every 500 ms it reads the path of the inner iframe and reports the victim’s current step to /youtube/api/current-page while changing the text of the fake address bar. The final redirect target is requested from /youtube/api/success-config and is chosen by the operator. Requests carry the headers X-Session-Token and X-Visitor-Id. No Telegram, webhook, WebSocket or socket.io channel exists in the client code; any such channel would be server-side.

Supported factors (from the step map of the script): e-mail/identifier, password, choice of the second-factor method, Google prompt on a device, an alternative device, phone number entry, SMS code, TOTP (authenticator application), code sent to a recovery e-mail and backup codes, plus a manual "incorrect, try again" step and a "session expired" step. The pages of these steps (/youtube/<step>/ with a session identifier) were not captured and need a valid session, so the actual fields and the credential submission endpoint are not established; the code does not show a passkey downgrade (neither confirmed nor excluded). This is an operator-in-the-loop relay kit, not a reverse-proxy AiTM.

Anti-analysis. script.js is obfuscated with obfuscator.io at the "high" preset (RC4 string array, self-defending, a debugger loop, disabled console output) and carries a domain lock that redirects to about:blank outside the allowed domains. The lock allows two further domains that currently resolve, ytchannelinfo[.]com and verify1you-be-main213047298[.]com (both behind Cloudflare); their role is not confirmed and they are most likely parallel or staging installations. The HTML hides its text in a closed Shadow DOM, uses random class names, fake Google jscontroller/jsaction attributes and hidden noise elements, and loads images through an API as blobs, to defeat hash-based signatures and scrapers.

Family markers (facts about the code, not an attribution): the engine name "collabix" (__collabixSkipAutoFocusOnce, collabix:introAnimationDone), build tag v=20261016h, Russian-language interface strings, hl=ru in a Google URL embedded in the fake address bar, and a tracking parameter that is saved as a partner (worker) code. Comparison with the PhaaS family described by Malwarebytes in April 2026 (same genre: fake YouTube copyright notice leading to a Google sign-in): the code shares none of its strings or API scheme, so a relation is not confirmed.

Goal: the Google account of the channel owner, including interception of second factors. Operator not identified.

Relation to the earlier case: on 13 October the same message had been seen as a screenshot only, with the visible domain youtube.studio (not registered since 2020) and an unknown target; that case was closed without a report pending the original message. The original is now available and the target is established. Comparison with the PhaaS family described by Malwarebytes in April 2026: shared genre (fake YouTube copyright notice), partner-type tracking parameter, sign-in overlay; differences: other endpoint names and API scheme, no Cyrillic homoglyphs. A relation is not confirmed by the code.

4. Relationship to Other Campaigns

A Hetzner-themed billing message investigated in parallel is not related to this campaign (High confidence): the infrastructure, the kit and the mailer have nothing in common.

5. Indicators of Compromise

All values are defanged. to_ids shows whether the value is suitable for blocking lists. share.google, groups.google.com and youtube.studio are not indicators.

Type	Value	Context / confidence	to_ids
IP	94[.]26[.]90[.]86	DMCA kit host (DEDIK, AS207043). Medium-High	true
Domain	copyright-library[.]com	Fake "DMCA strike" kit, registered 2026-10-03 (NiceNIC). High	true
Domain	dmcaalertsinfo[.]com	Related DMCA domain registered 2026-10-02; no longer resolving. Medium	true
Domain	ytchannelinfo[.]com	Allowed by the kit's domain lock; resolves (Cloudflare); role not confirmed, most likely a parallel or	true

		staging installation. Medium	
Domain	verify1you-be-main213047298[.]com	Allowed by the kit's domain lock; resolves (Cloudflare); role not confirmed, most likely a parallel or staging installation. Medium	true
String	/youtube/api/slot/claim	Kit backend: claims an operator slot (503 with live/collecting counters when slots are busy). High	false
String	/youtube/api/slot/ping	Kit backend: heartbeat every 5 s and channel for operator commands. High	false
String	/youtube/api/current-page	Kit backend: reports the victim's current step every 500 ms. High	false
String	/youtube/api/pushmfa-context	Kit backend: context for the fake Google-prompt step. High	false
String	/youtube/api/success-config	Kit backend: operator-defined final redirect. High	false
Header	X-Session-Token	Request header sent by the kit to its backend together with X-Visitor-Id. Medium	false
String	__collabixSkipAutoFocusOnce	Internal engine name "collabix" in the kit script (also the event collabix:introAnimationDone). High	false
String	v=20261016h	Build tag of script.js and modal.css (build of 16 October 2026). High	false
String	Все слоты сейчас заняты. Попробуйте через минуту.	Russian-language message shown to a victim when all operator slots are busy. High	false
String	58 Riverside Ave, Suite 200, Rockford, IL 61101	Fictitious company details of the "Copyright Library" landing (signature string). High	false
String	/api/submit-form	POST endpoint called before the sign-in overlay. High	false
String	auth-verifi/?continue_verifi_userID_182iqqUTqwjRequestYoutube	sign-in overlay iframe path (identical for every visitor). High	false
String	window.CL.getChannelInfo; "Copyright Library"	script object and page title. High	false

SHA256	0b2a4cd076aec476b99b9cb37c5eb7c95fe45cb7b3cfcd26c218012609118f3a	index page. High	false (page changes)
SHA256	a6c66736a96753a90cceadd02fbe5d607aa10b0c9cabfd75af15df3f65148238	sign-in overlay iframe page. High	false (page changes)
SHA256	e6fc7ee9483f9ecc388e6e0eededf062f7a4333fa92c4b7f8b53c855f6e87d62	script.js (obfuscator.io), 265,737 bytes. High	false (page changes)
SHA256	f59fc322ad252f01c9744811e871e40874dd90efdffee60cb88fd5d857db5450	assets/js/config.js. High	false (page changes)

6. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic	Technique	ID	Evidence / status
Reconnaissance	Gather Victim Host Information	T1592	The kit collects visitor IP (via a public IP-echo service) and OS. Confirmed (code)
Resource Development	Acquire Infrastructure: Domains	T1583.001	copyright-library[.]com, dmcaalertsinfo[.]com. Confirmed
Resource Development	Acquire Infrastructure: VPS	T1583.003	DEDIK server. Confirmed
Resource Development	Acquire Infrastructure: Web Services	T1583.006	Google Groups, share.google. Confirmed
Resource Development	Establish Accounts: Email Accounts	T1585.002	Consumer mail account used to post to a group. Possible
Resource Development	Stage Capabilities: Link Target	T1608.005	copyright-library[.]com. Confirmed
Initial Access	Phishing: Spearphishing Link	T1566.002	Link in the group message. Confirmed
Initial Access	Valid Accounts: Cloud Accounts	T1078.004	Goal: Google accounts of channel owners. Hypothesis
Execution	User Execution: Malicious Link	T1204.001	Click required. Confirmed (intent)
Defense Evasion	Impersonation	T1656	YouTube / DMCA notice. Confirmed
Defense Evasion	Masquerading: Match Legitimate Resource Name	T1036.005	Visible anchor text youtube.studio. Confirmed

	or Location		
Defense Evasion	Obfuscated Files or Information	T1027	obfuscator.io in script.js, DOM noise. Confirmed
Credential Access	Input Capture: Web Portal Capture	T1056.003	Password and second-factor entry pages inside a fake browser window; the entry pages were not captured. Probable (code)
Credential Access	Adversary-in-the-Middle	T1557	Operator-driven relay of the sign-in session in real time (slots, heartbeat commands). Confirmed (code)
Credential Access	Multi-Factor Authentication Interception	T1111	SMS, TOTP, backup-recovery e-mail, phone and backup-code steps. Confirmed (code)
Credential Access	Multi-Factor Authentication Request Generation	T1621	Fake Google-prompt step ("tap Yes"), operator-supplied context. Possible
Defense Evasion	Virtualization/Sandbox Evasion: System Checks	T1497.001	debugger loop, domain lock (about:blank outside allowed domains), DOM noise, closed Shadow DOM. Confirmed (code)

7. Detection

7.1 Mail

- Links to share.google/* in messages from googlegroups.com with brand wording (YouTube, DMCA, copyright).
- A message from a Google group whose display name imitates a vendor (YouTube, Google) and whose text asks to follow a link for a policy or copyright review.

7.2 Network and content (YARA / proxy / crawler strings)

- Kit strings: continue_verifi_userID_, /api/submit-form, window.CL.getChannelInfo, "Copyright Library — config.js", data-noise-json.
- Backend paths of the kit: /youtube/api/slot/claim, /youtube/api/slot/ping, /youtube/api/current-page, /youtube/api/pushmfa-context, /youtube/api/success-config; request header X-Session-Token (with X-Visitor-Id).
- Engine and build strings: __collabixSkipAutoFocusOnce, collabix:introAnimationDone, v=20261016h; the Russian-language text "Все слоты сейчас заняты. Попробуйте через минуту."; fictitious company details "58 Riverside Ave, Suite 200, Rockford, IL 61101".
- Behaviour: a POST to .../slot/claim answered with HTTP 503 and a JSON body with live/collecting counters (all operator slots busy); a page that periodically POSTs to .../slot/ping and .../current-page; a page that redirects to about:blank outside a hard-coded list of domains.
- Newly issued certificates and new names on 94[.]26[.]90[.]86 should be treated as new waves; a request to /api/submit-form with a JSON body of channel and visitor data precedes the sign-in overlay.

8. Recommendations

Immediate actions

- If anyone ever entered a password or a code on a page like this (a window that looks like a Google sign-in inside a web page), change the Google password immediately, sign out all sessions, review recovery options and use Google Security Checkup. Prefer passkeys or security keys: codes and prompts can be relayed by an operator in real time.

- A genuine sign-in window is a separate browser window or a system dialog, not part of the page: its address bar cannot be dragged inside the page content.
- Block or alert on the indicators marked to_ids=true.
- Add the detection rules of section 7 to the mail gateway and the web proxy.
- Check YouTube strikes only in YouTube Studio opened directly; enable a passkey or 2-step verification and run Google Security Checkup; leave Google groups you did not join deliberately and filter their messages.
- Treat messages from Google groups as untrusted by default: Google signs them, but the content is written by the poster. Allow group delivery only for groups you know.

Long-term mitigations

- Mail security should not treat Google signatures or the google.com domain in a link chain as a trust signal: resolve the short-link target before scoring.
- Put 94[.]26[.]90[.]86 under passive-DNS and certificate monitoring.
- Google-side: abuse of share.google short links and of group posts for brand impersonation should be handled by the service operator.

9. Confidence and Limitations

Conclusion	Confidence
The message is credential phishing	High
The kit target is copyright-library[.]com; the kit is a BitB relay with a live operator (from static analysis of the script)	High
Supported factors: password, Google prompt, SMS, TOTP, recovery e-mail, phone, backup codes (from the step map)	High / Medium
ytchannelinfo[.]com and verify1you-be-main213047298[.]com are allowed by the domain lock and resolve; that they host the same kit is an assumption	Medium
The kit belongs to the PhaaS family of April 2026 (not confirmed by the code)	Not confirmed
Not related to the parallel Hetzner-themed message	High
Operator identity	Not established

Gaps: the sign-in step pages and the credential submission endpoint were not captured (they require a valid session), a passkey downgrade is neither confirmed nor excluded, and any server-side operator channel is not visible; certificate-transparency data for dmcaalertsinfo[.]com was unavailable; the group itself could not be inspected. All pages and indicators reflect the state of 21 October 2026.

10. References

- Malwarebytes, 15 April 2026, "Fake YouTube copyright notices can steal your Google login".
- Mimecast, "Google Redirect Abuse"; TechRepublic, "Trusted Google Alerts Hijacked" (abuse of Google redirectors in phishing).
- Passive DNS, certificate transparency, RDAP/WHOIS, public URL-scan archives and public abuse databases (state of 21 October 2026).

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